

INTO THE UNKNOWN

Final Major Project Pre-Production Pitch
Sam Lodge

DATEF

INTO THE DUNGEON is a first-person Action RPG for the PC. You will be able to create a fully customizable character where you can change the appearance and skills. The skills will determine how well the player character performs at a given task.

The game will be set in a vast dungeon deep underground. It is filled with criminals and innocents imprisoned for life; the player will explore the dungeon talking to NPC's and increasing their skills.



PROJECT AIMS

PERSONAL GOALS

- Challenge my technical ability in Unreal Engine
- Create a fully realised story of my own design

OVERALL AIM

- Create a good portfolio piece
- Have something to impress employers
- Make a fun game

PROFESSIONAL GOALS



HELLO
GAMES



CREATIVE
ASSEMBLY™



The Chinese Room

A Sumo Digital Studio

In industry I would like to go into a **Gameplay Designer** role. I feel the most passionate about making and implementing satisfying gameplay into games.

I am also very interested in the Indie and AA scenes as that is the majority of games I play but am unsure about how they differ from AAA developers.

INSPIRATIONS

My key inspirations for the project are Dungeons and Dragons, Elder Scrolls IV: Oblivion, and Caves of Qud. They are all RPG's that I enjoy, and they all have a different approach to player progression and customisation. Dnd lets you be anyone you want, Oblivion has you able to create goofy looking characters and Qud limits the player to one of five preset sprites for the player.

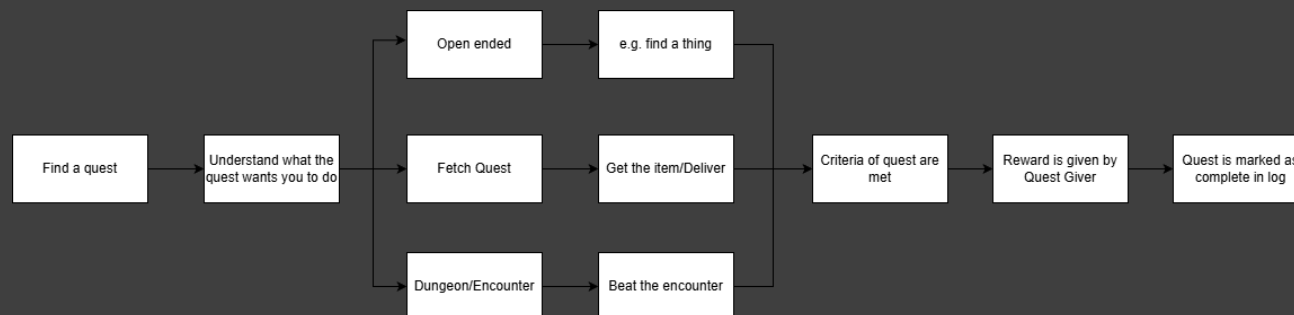


GAMEPLAY

The core gameplay loop will follow the graph on the left.

For Pre-Production I will be focusing on creating the systems that the gameplay loop will follow.

There will be a Melee and Magic combat system that the player can engage in combat with.



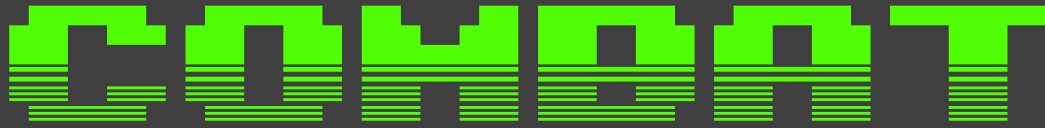
WHAT'S THE HOOK?

RPGs are an incredibly saturated genre; they are typically big AAA blockbusters like Skyrim and Mass Effect. But they lack tension in combat, its either win or lose and more often than not it's always a win.

I will be implementing a Tabletop-RPG style chance to hit system, nothing in life is guaranteed so why should a fire ball?

This will be based off of the players Luck stat and a random number; the actual damage will be displayed through the intensity of visual effects like blood or sparks from weapons.

Keeping the system balanced while keeping player progression feel satisfying will be difficult but the iteration of the levelling system will be done in Production.



Both systems work with together and the player can cast spells and attack without having to unequip one and equip another.

MAGIC

Rather than a simple meter of how many spells you can cast my system will be more fluid and act more like how many spells your character can tolerate casting in any given combat encounter.

MELEE

A simple melee system with a few different weapon types (Short Sword, Long Sword, Axes, Spears, etc)

You'll be able to block with and without a shield but blocking without only protects you from a small amount of damage.

SETTING

As mentioned earlier the game will be set in a vast dungeon underneath a city.

The Dungeon was originally intended to be a high security prison for only the worst of society, but as time moved forward more people were punished with life in The Dungeon.

Eventually, a subterranean society emerged from the prisoners and small communities formed. Many people live in these communities but many of the worse criminals formed organisations in opposition. Around five thousand people live in The Dungeon and despite years of searching no escape has been found.



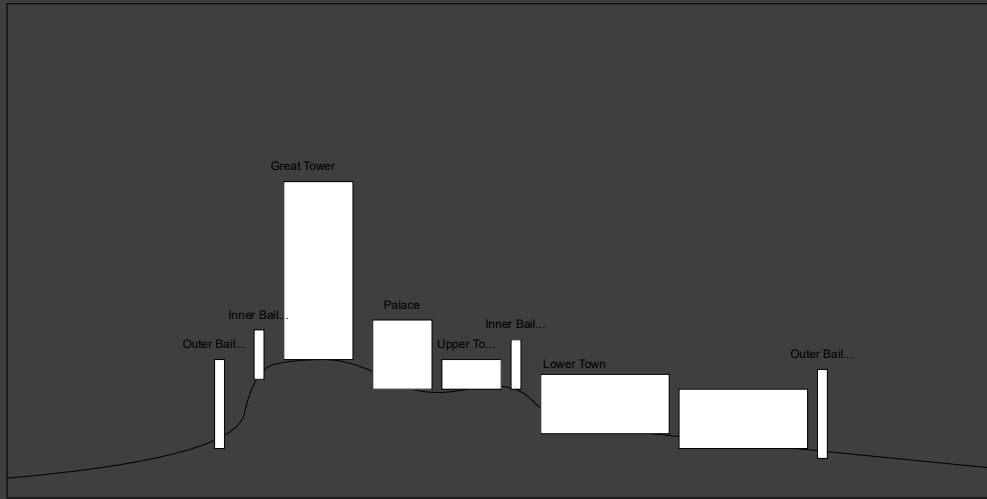


Into The Dungeon starts with a trial where the player is being charged with an unknown crime. They get a dialogue choice whether to plead guilty or innocent to the charges but regardless of what they pick they are sentenced to life imprisonment in The Dungeon.

Then they are blindfolded and thrown down a deep pit. Here they wake up and follow through a basic tutorial where they learn how to walk, jump, crouch, look around, and pick up items. Then they go through character creation.

Next the player encounters a tutorial NPC who is an enchanted Skull, who has been cursed with eternal life. It basically functions to teach the player more complex mechanics.

LEVEL DESIGN



The overall level design will primarily consist of corridors connecting into larger set piece areas akin to how the Half Life 1 and Dark Souls 1 structured their levels.

I want the level to make the player feel claustrophobic as they progress throughout the game. Each level should connect to one another and feel like a classic dungeon from old-school CRPGS like Daggerfall and Diablo 1.



Design for previous Idea



Goals for Pre-Production

- Melee Combat
- Magic Combat
- Enemy/NPC AI
- Dialogue System
- Skills/Levelling
- Character Creation (Character & stats)
- Level Design
- Plot/Setting

Goals for Production

- Finalised plot
- Script
- Voice Acting - Out source
- Sound/Music - Out source
- Blockout
- Weapon/Armour/Spell Variety
- Completed Build